

Youssef Garas

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EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science (Cybersecurity) | Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA

May 2026

GPA: 3.90 | **Certifications:** CompTIA Security+, Cisco CCNA | **Languages:** English, Arabic, German

Relevant Coursework: Computer Networks, Operating Systems, Data Structures and Algorithms, Software Engineering

PROJECTS

Home Lab: Secure Network & Remote Access | *Caddy, WireGuard/Tailscale, AdGuard Home, ufw, fail2ban, PKI/TLS*

- Designed a Caddy reverse-proxy architecture terminating TLS and routing traffic to 8+ backend services via host/subdomain routing (SNI + Host header) over a Docker bridge network.
- Built and operate a private internal Certificate Authority for automatic TLS issuance to internal-only DNS names, distributing the root CA to trust stores across Linux hosts and browsers.
- Engineered WireGuard-based remote access (Tailscale) from behind carrier-grade NAT with no public IP, advertising an entire /24 LAN through one subnet-router node and configuring split DNS for roaming clients.
- Implemented a defense-in-depth baseline across hosts: ed25519 key-only SSH (password and root login disabled), fail2ban wired to journald, and default-deny ufw firewalls with least-privilege LAN-scoped rules.

Home Lab: Linux Server & Container Platform | *Debian 13, Docker Compose, systemd, Git, restic, Backblaze B2*

- Authored and maintain a version-controlled Docker Compose stack of 9+ containers (media server, automation apps, DNS, reverse proxy, Portainer) as Infrastructure-as-Code in Git.
- Built an encrypted, deduplicated offsite backup pipeline (restic to Backblaze B2 object storage) automated with systemd timers and daily/weekly/monthly retention, using a least-privilege bucket-scoped credential.
- Validated backups with a real test restore, then used the pipeline in production twice: as the mechanism for a cross-host migration and for point-in-time rollback of a database after a breaking upgrade.

Cisco CCNA Lab Work | *Cisco IOS, Packet Tracer, OSPF, HSRP, VLANs, STP, EtherChannel, NAT, ACLs*

- Built a multi-office capstone network from scratch twice on a hierarchical core/distribution/access design: VLANs, VTP, Rapid STP, EtherChannel, HSRP gateway redundancy, OSPF, NAT, DHCP, and a wireless LAN controller with lightweight APs.
- Secured access layers with port security, DHCP snooping, Dynamic ARP Inspection, standard and extended ACLs, and SSH-only device management.

Automated Facial Recognition Door Lock | *Python, OpenCV, KNN, JSON*

- Developed a biometric access-control system using OpenCV Haar cascade classifiers for real-time face detection and a K-Nearest Neighbors classifier for identification.
- Raised recognition accuracy to 95% with feature normalization, enabling reliable continuous authentication.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Endpoint Intern | McKenney's | Atlanta, GA

May 2026 - Present

- Handle security incident tickets end to end: evaluate each case, communicate with affected users and stakeholders, and carry out containment and recovery actions, including restoring breached accounts to a secure state, reconnecting endpoints, and releasing devices from network quarantine.
- Monitored and triaged critical security alerts in SentinelOne (EDR), investigating and evaluating threat incidents to strengthen endpoint protection.
- Authored and deployed custom remediation scripts through Quest KACE and Automox to systematically identify and patch vulnerable applications across company workstations and servers.
- Spearheaded an OS upgrade initiative in Automox, managing and deploying updates to reach 100% Windows 25H2 compliance across hundreds of enterprise endpoints.
- Engineered a company-wide Workato automation that generates Microsoft Entra ID Temporary Access Passes (TAPs), accelerating device upgrades and deployments while eliminating the security risk of users sharing passwords.

Technical Director & Lead Graphics Operator | Leading the Way (Independent Contractor) | Atlanta, GA

Sep 2022 - May 2026

- Led international television broadcasts reaching 260+ million viewers across the Middle East via three satellite networks (Nilesat, Arabsat, Hotbird), running Xpression graphics with zero-error transmission under live pressure.
- Translated and transcribed on-air graphics from English to Arabic in real time, saving the team hours of preparation per broadcast.

Knack Tutor | Georgia State University | Atlanta, GA

Aug 2025 - May 2026

- Tutored students in Linear Algebra, CS 1302, and Physics 1211, helping them improve by an average of one letter grade on assessments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security: Incident triage and response, SentinelOne (EDR), Huntress, Cisco Umbrella, vulnerability remediation, patch management (Automox, Quest KACE), SSH/endpoint hardening, fail2ban, ufw, PKI/TLS, OpenSSL, least privilege

Networking: Cisco IOS, Cisco Meraki, OSPF, HSRP, VLANs, STP, EtherChannel, NAT, ACLs, DNS, DHCP, WireGuard/Tailscale, Caddy, Wireshark

Systems & Scripting: Linux (Debian), systemd, Docker Compose, Git, restic, Entra ID, Active Directory, Workato, PowerShell, Bash, Python, SQL